

Kim Clegg

July 28, 2026

RE: Formal Request for Investigation into Student Safety, Bullying Response, and Special Education Concerns at Vista Charter School

Dear Members of the Board,

I am writing as the parent of two students at Vista Charter School to formally request an investigation into a pattern of concerns that has developed over the past several years, involving inadequate response to bullying and threats, breakdowns in special education services, and a school culture that appears to be affecting both students and staff. I am raising this with the board because attempts to resolve these issues directly with school administration have not led to lasting improvement.

We chose Vista Charter School specifically for its reputation in the arts and because my sister, who has a professional background in both special education and elementary education, was someone we hoped would be part of both our daughters' education there. That is no longer possible. Due to the extent of the bullying my younger daughter has experienced, we are now facing the decision to move her to homeschool or a hybrid program rather than keep her in a full-time classroom setting at Vista.

1. Ongoing Bullying and Unreported Threats of Violence (Youngest, just finished 2nd grade)

My youngest daughter has experienced bullying every year she has attended Vista, from kindergarten through this past school year. I have email correspondence with school administration documenting concerns raised in all three years. Despite this documented history, the situation has not improved and has, at times, escalated to physical harm and threats of violence.

Specific incidents include:

- During recess, my daughter and her friends have hidden in the girls' restroom to get away from a group of boys, because they felt it was the only safe place to be.

- One of her friends was physically thrown to the ground by boys at school as part of what the children called a "shock test."
- Last school year, a student told my daughter and her friends that he was going to kill them because he was upset. Administration was made aware of this. The students involved were brought into the office and spoken to, but no formal incident report was filed because Administration classified it as a "Level 1" situation — a classification that, by the school's own stated policy, should have required a report. I was not notified of this incident by the school.

I began recording my conversations with my youngest because of the volume and consistency of what she was telling me about her experiences at school. In response to the pattern of bullying, the administration's proposed remedy has been to install an additional camera in the yard — a measure that does not address the underlying culture or the failure to follow reporting policy when a credible threat was made.

I have also spoken with other Vista parents who describe similar experiences with their own children, which suggests this is not isolated to my daughter but reflects a broader pattern at the school.

2. Inconsistent Communication About Special Education Services (older daughter, just completed 5th grade)

My older daughter has an IEP, and I have consistently struggled to get clear, consistent information from the school about her progress and services. The information I receive often contradicts itself within a short period of time.

For example, at an IEP meeting with her full team of teachers, I was told she was close to being ready to graduate from her services. The following week, I received a phone call from the school requesting to place her in an additional period of services in place of an elective — the opposite of what I had just been told. I did not consent to this change because it did not align with what the team had told me a week earlier.

3. No Backup Plan During a Fire Alarm for a Student With PTSD (older daughter)

My older daughter has PTSD related to fire. Her IEP accommodations include being pulled aside and supported during planned fire drills. During an actual, unplanned fire alarm at the school, her regular special education teacher — the staff member responsible for supporting her in these situations — was off-site for training. No one at the school checked on her or provided her with support during or after the alarm. By the time she got home that day, several hours later, she was still severely dysregulated and reverting to baby talk as a result of the trauma. This incident indicates there is no adequate backup plan in place to ensure accommodations are met when the assigned staff member is unavailable.

4. Administrative Culture and Its Impact on Staff and Students

My older daughter got a new STEM teacher two days before Christmas break and no email was sent out. Beyond the incidents involving my children directly, I have serious concerns about how administration treats teachers and staff at Vista. From what I have observed and been told, the workplace culture has become a toxic one, which I believe affects staff retention and, in turn, the consistency and quality of care and instruction students receive.

Requested Actions

Given the pattern described above, I am requesting that the board:

- Open a formal investigation into how Vista Charter School handles and reports bullying and threat incidents, including why the threat made against my daughter and her friends was not formally reported despite staff acknowledging awareness of it.
- Review whether the school's bullying incident classifications and reporting practices comply with the school's own stated policy and any applicable state charter school requirements.
- Review the special education program's communication practices with parents, including how service recommendations are determined and communicated, to prevent the kind of contradictory guidance my family has experienced.
- Review emergency and drill procedures to ensure that students with documented accommodations, such as my daughter's PTSD-related fire alarm support, are covered by a backup plan when their assigned staff member is unavailable.
- Look into the working conditions and turnover among teaching staff at Vista, given the potential connection between staff treatment and the consistency of care students receive.
- Schedule a meeting with me and other affected families to discuss these concerns directly.

I have email documentation spanning three years regarding bullying concerns for my younger daughter, as well as records related to my older daughter's IEP meetings and services, and I am glad to provide these to support this request.

Vista is a lottery-admission charter school, and families choose it based on trust in what it represents. I do not believe these issues will resolve on their own, and I am asking the board to intervene so that other children do not experience what my daughters have experienced. Thank you for your time and attention to this matter. I look forward to your response.

Sincerely,

Kim Clegg

Parent of students at Vista Charter School